

Saturday, 18 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

23° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 14°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

22° 14°

GLASGOW

Partly cloudy

23° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- The new Labour leader, Andy Burnham, has promised the biggest change in British politics for 40 years.**
In his first speech since winning the leadership race, Mr Burnham outlined his vision for the country. He is set to become Prime Minister on Monday, succeeding Sir Keir Starmer.

POLITICS · UK

- London Mayor Sadiq Khan is among 26 new peers who will be taking their seats in the House of Lords.**
Broadcaster June Sarpong and former union chief Christina McAnea are also on the list. The appointments will see a significant intake of new members into the Lords.

POLITICS · UK

- A new targeted treatment for prostate cancer could significantly reduce the risk of side effects, a study suggests.**
An NHS trial followed almost 3,500 men over ten years who received focal therapy. This less invasive approach offers hope for improved patient outcomes.

HEALTH · UK

- The Bayeux Tapestry has been seen in the UK for the first time in almost a thousand years, as it prepares for display.**
The 70-metre-long 11th-century embroidery arrived from France last week. It will soon be on public view at the British Museum.

CULTURE · UK

- Firefighters are battling a wildfire in the Cairngorms for a third day, with a helicopter being used to waterbomb the blaze.**
More than 50 firefighters are tackling the fire, which started in heathland near Nethy Bridge. Efforts are ongoing to bring it under control.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1 Paralympian Dame Sarah Storey, a multi-medal winner for Great Britain, has been confirmed for this year's Strictly Come Dancing line-up.

Dame Sarah is the seventh celebrity to be announced for the popular dance competition. Fans are keen to see how she takes to the ballroom.

ON AIR – What an incredible career Dame Sarah has had! Do you think her sporting discipline will give her an edge on the dancefloor?

TV · AUTUMN 2026

2 Sir Christopher Nolan's new film, 'The Odyssey', starring Matt Damon and Zendaya, is being hailed by critics as a 'colossal piece of cinema'.

This is Nolan's first movie since his Oscar-winning 'Oppenheimer'. Early reviews suggest it's another epic hit for the acclaimed director.

ON AIR – Nolan's films always spark debate! Are you a fan of his work, and what are your expectations for 'The Odyssey'?

FILM · COMING SOON

3 Ten previously unheard tracks from David Bowie's early career are set to be released, offering a rare glimpse into his beginnings.

These newly discovered recordings are from the 1960s, when Bowie performed under the name Davie Jones. It's a treat for fans and music historians alike.

ON AIR – What a find for Bowie fans! Are there any other artists whose early, unheard material you'd love to get your hands on?

MUSIC · COMING SOON

4 The stars of 'Heartstopper', Kit Connor and Joe Locke, say making the film adaptation of the popular series will 'forever be important'.

The Netflix movie brings Alice Oseman's beloved screen adaptation to a conclusion. It's been a huge hit with audiences around the world.

ON AIR – Heartstopper has resonated with so many people. What do you think makes a story like this so important and impactful?

FILM · COMING SOON

5 A new photograph has been released to mark Queen Camilla's 79th birthday, showing her renewed commitment to supporting children's literacy.

The Queen is celebrating her birthday with a focus on her passion for encouraging reading among young people. She continues her work with various literacy charities.

ON AIR – It's lovely to see the Queen championing children's literacy. What book sparked your love of reading as a child?

ROYALS · TODAY

On the schedule

1 **Sam Burns has tied a major championship record with an incredible round of 62 at The Open Championship at Royal Birkdale.**

Burns holed out from a bunker on the 18th to join Lucas Herbert in equalling the lowest round at a men's major. It was a truly spectacular finish to his second round.

ON AIR – What a way to finish a round! Have you ever seen a more dramatic or impressive shot in golf?

GOLF · UK

2 **Australia's Lucas Herbert narrowly missed out on golf history at The Open, bogeying the 18th to finish with a record-equalling 62.**

Herbert had a five-foot putt for a record-breaking round of 61 but pulled it wide. Despite the disappointment, it was still an amazing performance at Royal Birkdale.

ON AIR – So close to making history! How do you think Lucas Herbert will feel about that missed putt after such an incredible round?

GOLF · UK

3 **Hampshire's Liam Dawson and Somerset's Tom Banton will be released from England duty to play in Saturday's T20 Blast Finals Day.**

Both players will feature for their respective counties in the highly anticipated domestic cricket event. It's a big boost for their teams.

ON AIR – It's always exciting when international players return for domestic finals! Which team are you backing for T20 Blast glory?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Spain's former captain Cesar Azpilicueta says the team's strong identity will be key as they prepare for Sunday's World Cup final.**

Spain will face Argentina in the highly anticipated final, with Azpilicueta confident in his side's collective strength. They are hoping to lift the trophy.

ON AIR – Spain or Argentina for the World Cup? Who are you putting your money on, and why?

FOOTBALL · INTERNATIONAL

5 **Thousands of tickets are still available for Saturday's World Cup bronze medal match between England and France.**

Around 7,000 tickets are listed on FIFA's official sites for the third-place play-off. It's a chance for fans to see two top teams battle it out.

ON AIR – England v France for third place - is it a match you'd be keen to go and see, or does the bronze medal feel less exciting?

FOOTBALL · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new appreciation for the sounds of 'historic clock towers' is chiming across communities.**
Residents are finding a surprising comfort in the rhythmic bongs and chimes, seeing them as a reassuring connection to the past in our fast-paced world.
- 2 The humble 'teatowel' is having a moment, becoming a canvas for intricate designs and sentimental value.**
No longer just for drying up, people are collecting bespoke teatowels as souvenirs and even framing them as quirky kitchen art.
- 3 A delightful trend sees people leaving 'surprise positive notes' in public places for strangers to discover.**
These small acts of kindness, often tucked into library books or on park benches, are spreading unexpected joy and a sense of connection.
- 4 More people are rediscovering the tactile pleasure and mental benefits of 'sorting through old photographs'.**
It's a lovely way to reminisce, tell family stories, and digitally preserve memories that might otherwise be forgotten in dusty boxes.
- 5 The art of 'creating miniature gardens' in unusual containers is blossoming in urban areas.**
From old teacups to discarded wellington boots, these tiny green havens offer a splash of nature and creativity even in the smallest spaces.
- 6 A surprising number of people are finding calm in the simple act of 'polishing household silver or cherished trinkets'.**
It's being hailed as a mindful activity, offering a sense of accomplishment and a moment of quiet focus away from screens.
- 7 The resurgence of 'letter writing' is bringing a personal touch back to communication.**
People are enjoying the slower pace and thoughtful process of putting pen to paper, creating tangible keepsakes for friends and family.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out which way to go in an unfamiliar place, even though it rarely helps?

ANSWER: ...SPINNING AROUND ON THE SPOT, HOPING TO MAGICALLY FACE THE RIGHT DIRECTION!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'item' that they absolutely have to rescue first in a game of pretend 'desert island dilemma'?

ANSWER: ...THEIR FAVOURITE MUG FOR THAT ALL-IMPORTANT BREW!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you catch a 'glimpse of a familiar building' from an unexpected angle, and it suddenly looks completely different?**
What's a local landmark or a well-known building that you've seen from a new perspective recently, and it totally changed how you view it?

- **We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that are so specific to a particular season, don't we?**
What's a sound that instantly makes you think of summer, whether it's the distant thwack of a cricket bat or the buzz of a particularly determined bee?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** Did you know that there's a planet made almost entirely of diamond? It's called 55 Cancri e and is twice the size of Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that astronauts can grow up to two inches taller in space because there's no gravity to compress their spines?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£9.5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£9.5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public park was Birkenhead Park in Merseyside, inspiring New York's Central Park.
- A group of owls is collectively known as a 'parliament'.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- In Japan, it's customary to eat KFC for Christmas dinner.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The 'king' of a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat, primarily brine shrimp and algae.

On this day

Day 199 of the year, 166 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Arnulf of Metz; Christian feast day: Bruno of Segni; Christian feast day: Camillus de Lellis (optional memorial, United States only); Christian feast day: Eadburh (or Edburga) of Bicester. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Elizabeth McGovern, American actress
- 1954 — Ricky Skaggs, American singer-songwriter, mandolin player, and producer
- 1982 — Ryan Cabrera, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1975 — Daron Malakian, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1967 — Vin Diesel, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1934 — Darlene Conley, American actress (died 2007)
- 1985 — Chace Crawford, American actor
- 1932 — Robert Ellis Miller, American director and screenwriter (died 2017)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1925 — Adolf Hitler publishes Mein Kampf.
- 1994 — Rwandan genocide: The Rwandan Patriotic Front takes control of Gisenyi and north western Rwanda, forcing the interim government into Zaire and ending the genocide.
- 1996 — Battle of Mullaitivu: The Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam capture the Sri Lanka Army's base, killing over 1,200 soldiers.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1942 — The Germans test fly the Messerschmitt Me 262 using its jet engines for the first time.
- 2013 — The Government of Detroit, with up to \$20 billion in debt, files for the largest municipal bankruptcy in U.S. history.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1984 — McDonald's massacre in San Ysidro, California: James Oliver Huberty kills 21 people and injures 19 others before being shot dead by police.
- 1996 — Battle of Mullaitivu: The Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam capture the Sri Lanka Army's base, killing over 1,200 soldiers.

- 1968 — Intel is founded in Mountain View, California.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 200 of the year, 165 days left in 2026. Today Palace Day; Christian feast day: Aurea of Córdoba; Christian feast day: Bernold, Bishop of Utrecht; Christian feast day: John Plessington. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1992 — Jake Nicholson, English footballer
- 1983 — Helen Skelton, English television host and actress
- 1961 — Campbell Scott, American actor, director, and producer
- 1944 — Tim McIntire, American actor and singer (died 1986)
- 1998 — Erin Cuthbert, Scottish footballer
- 1950 — Freddy Moore, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2022)
- 1937 — Richard Jordan, American actor (died 1993)
- 1947 — Bernie Leadon, American guitarist and songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2011 — Guinean President Alpha Condé survives an attempted assassination and coup d'état at his residence in Conakry.
- 1957 — The largely autobiographical novel *The Ordeal of Gilbert Pinfold* by Evelyn Waugh was published.
- 1972 — Dhofar Rebellion: British SAS units help the Omani government against Popular Front for the Liberation of Oman rebels in the Battle of Mirbat.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1989 — United Airlines Flight 232 crashes in Sioux City, Iowa, killing 111.
- 1979 — The oil tanker SS Atlantic Empress collides with another oil tanker, causing the largest ever ship-borne oil spill.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)